Similarly, Maulana Hassan Jan was killed at Swat for preaching moderation. Maulana Sarfraz Naeemi of Jamia Naeemia Lahore was killed in a suicide attack on his Madrasah at Garhi Shahu, Lahore, for issuing 'fatwa' against suicide attacks. The other prominent clerics who were eliminated include Maulana Yusuf Ludhianvi, Maulana Habibullah, Mufti Nizamuddin Shamzai, Mufti Abdus Sami, Mufti Atiqur Rehman, Mufti Jamil Khan, Maulana Noor Muhammad, Maulana Aslam Sheikhupuri (Karachi) and Maulana Syed Mohsin Shah (Darra Pezu, KP). Rahimullah Yusufzai, resident editor of daily The News, was of the view that most of the cases remained unresolved due to 'political compulsions or due to the government's incompetence'. Tahir-ul-Qadri, a religious scholar (Barelvi) having a large following in Punjab, wrote a book to oppose suicide bombing, which earned him the wrath of TTP that he had to escape from Pakistan. He returned to Pakistan in June 2014.

Terrorism

The TTP started expanding its area of influence and activities out of the region of Pashtun ethnicity and the precincts of FATA and KP (formerly NWFP) by employing 'the unlawful use of force or violence to intimidate the government and the civilian population, in furtherance of its objectives'. This strategy was twofold: first, to develop sympathisers and supporters in new groups and areas; second, to carry out terrorist activities in these areas. A number of devastating suicide attacks, such as those on FIA Building Lahore; Naval War College, Lahore; Islamabad Marriot Hotel; Wah Ordnance Factory (2008); Sri Lankan cricket team, Lahore; Manawan Police Training School, Lahore, GHQ, Rawalpindi; Elite Police Training School and bomb blasts in Peshawar (2009), revealed the intent and intensity of its designs.

A ban on TTP in 2008 did little to deter its militants as they carried out 12 suicide attacks in Punjab in the same year. These attacks showed the group's growing network of allies among the local criminal and extremist groups, particularly in the Seraiki belt of southern Punjab. A better picture of the terror sans frontiers was revealed during the investigation of the September 2008 bombing of the Islamabad Marriot Hotel. Of the more than 250 suspects arrested from southern Punjab, a large number of them belonged to LJ, JeM, LeT, SSP, TJP and SMP. It was clear then that the Taliban were no longer a purely Pashtun movement. The members of terrorist and sectarian organisations from